

Here foloweth a lytell treatyse of  
**the Beaute**  
**of Women**

newly translated out of Frenshe in to Englyshe



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FOLOWETH A LYTELL TREATYSE OF THE BEAUTE OF WOMEN  
NEWLY TRANSLATED OUT OF FRENSE IN TO ENGLYSHE \*\*\*

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Here foloweth a lytell treatyse of the Beaute of  
Women

newly translated out of Frenshe in to Englyshe.



The sōne of the mayde whome neuer none resembled  
In beaulte nor bounte syth the worlde began  
For both in hyr were perfaytely assembled  
Named is she Marye doughter to saynt Anne  
Guyde myne hande so that the gentylman  
That me desyred to reduce thys boke  
From frenshe to englyshe / be content / and than  
I take lytell cure what other there on loke.

In frenshe (la beaute de femmes) is yt named  
The beaulte of women / in our Englyshe languag  
wherof to treat / I ought well to be blamed  
Consydered that I had neuer the vsage  
womens beaulte in body nor vysage  
For to regarde / and there vpon good reason  
Syth I am made (as an vnpleasant page)  
A cast a way from presence at eche season

But what therof shall I leue of to wryte  
Syth no man hauyng more practyse then I  
wyll take the payne to set blacke on the whyte  
And yt a thyng so dygne of memory  
Nay trust me playne I shall my selffe applye  
Of the frenshe boke to folow the sentence  
Beaulte (as ryght requireth) to gloryfye  
what euer foloweth of the consequence

what caused the wourthy Troylus of Troye  
To cast hys loue on Cresyde the shene  
why set Parys on fayre Helayne hys ioye  
what caused Achylles to loue Poleyne  
why loued Trystram la belle Isoude the quene  
Or Arthur of bretayne the fayre Florence  
All cam of theyr beaulte and theyr plesant eyen  
what haue I to do as of the consequence.

Beaulte as for the fyrste require wolde  
That the womam (how euer stande the case)

Symple manyer and countenaunce sholde holde  
For otherwyse she wyll avoyde the place

womans beaulte eche person reproueth  
yf so be that she bayre the countenaunce  
More eleuate or hygh than yt behoueth  
Hyr beaulte tourneth but all to dysplesance

Beaulte requireth as for the seconde parte  
That woman bayre euer naturally  
Symple regade and not ouerthwarte  
wyth playsante and symple castyng of the eye

Beaulte is lost in woman outtrelly  
yf she haue thys of very condycyon  
As to regarde or loke dyspyteously  
For that is the manner of the lyon

womans beaulte requireth thyrdely  
That stedfastly with out oultrage  
She kepe as dyscrete cōtynually  
Symple answer euer in her language

womans beaulte that sholde be magnyfied  
Lyetly compassed in these thre poyntes onely  
what beaulte so euer is to her applyed  
The woman ought to lede hyr lyffe symply

Beaulte of suerty doeth that woman folowe  
That hath the browes and raynes of the backe  
And there withall the fete lyght and holowe  
yf these thre be holowe there is no lacke.

Beaulte in woman is nothyng pleasant  
That glometh with her eyen with frowarde chere  
And is of hyr raynes so heuy and pesant  
And of hyr fete as yf a beest yt were

womans beaulte shall ve fvynde doubtlesse

womans beaulte shal ye fynde goodly  
In thre hygh poyntes that on hyr body gent  
Ought for to be / & them I shall expresse  
Here after / yf my remembraunce assent

Beaulte sayeth / the fyrst poynt to knowe  
The woman sholde haue the forhed hygh & fayre  
For whan she hath the forhed ouer lowe  
Euyll hyr besemeth a frontelet to bayre

womans beaulte requyreth secondly  
Of beaulte a ryght who that enquire wolde  
That woman ought to haue the hed hygh  
The better therwyth hyr hat she doeth vpholde

Beaulte in woman playnly doeth habounde  
yf she ne fayle as for the thyrde parte  
To haue the brestes hygh fayre and rounde  
wyth fyne gorgias well and fayre couert

womans beaulte as in preemynence  
Requireth these thre poyntes pryncypall  
For to be founde vpon hyr corpulence  
And well on hyght they ought for to be all

womans beaulte expresly for to showe  
As to the regarde of hyr countenaunce  
Requireth ouer thys to haue thre poyntes lowe  
whyche all women ought to haue in remembraunce

womans beaulte that purchase wyll praysyng  
woll that the woman set her besy cure  
To maynteyne in hyr selfe a low laughyng  
To laugh ouer hygh besemeth no creature

Beaulte yet cōmaundeth afterwarde  
Vnto all women thys poynt secondely  
To haue alwayes a lowely regarde  
Not ouer moche but moderately

That woman hath the bent of beaultyes bowe  
That can regarde in helth and in dysease  
whan she shall neese to make the sounde but lowe  
To do otherwyse yt may no person please

womans beaulte wyll in conclusyon  
Of these lowe poyntes without desloyaulte  
That women bere euer a lowly condycyon  
For otherwyse she leseth her beaulte.

Beaulte demaundeth these poyntes to haue sene  
In women that be fayre and fayte at all  
To haue trayteys the browes / and traytys eyen  
And lytell the handes / traytys slendre and small

Beaulte hath she that hath the chyn dympled  
The ioyntes of the handes sholde be in lyke manere  
The chekes also be they bare or wympled  
Especially whan she smyleth with hyr chere.

Beaulte requireth large to haue these thre  
The fyrste is the space goyng from eye to eye  
Betwyxt the sholdres sholde the seconde be  
The thyrde betwyxt the raynes ye shall espye.

Perfayt beaulte ye may well determyne  
In woman / so that these thre in hyr repayre  
The nayles and the lyppes cōplexyon sanguyne  
And ruddy the chekes well vermayled and fayre

womans beaulte thou doest well expose  
Or mayst expose wythout taryeng  
yf thou retayne in thy mynde close  
All that is set before in this wrytyng.

Of beaulte yf there be any woman  
More purely sped than is cōprysed in this  
was neuer woman svth the worlde began

So perfaityly sped of beaulte as she is

I haue expressed theyr preemynence  
As well of theyr bodyes as of theyr mayntyen  
But speke what ye wyll apert or in scylence  
Beaulte sans bonte ne vault rien.

Beaultyes there be in women infynyte  
But of bontyes there is but lytell speche  
Beaulte is them geuen as thyng requisyte  
who wyll haue bonte let hym go seche  
Thys not wythstandyng I coulde a man teche  
To fynde ryght good of the gendre feminyn  
And fayre also / but what euer we preche  
Beaulte sans bonte ne vault rien.

Beaulte ennobleth the person doubtlesse  
And playnly she is of the more valeure  
But wyth beaulte is requisyte goodnesse  
To speke a ryght who so wyll sett hys cure  
Bonte wyll not be vnder coverture  
where euer she be / hyr purete is so fyne  
wherfore I set agayne in thys scrypture  
Beaulte sans bonte ne vault rien.

Mayde / wyfe / or wydowe / dame / or damoyzell  
That haue the raye of beaulte comprysed in your face  
Adioustherto bonte / than shall ye do ryght well  
For beaulte with bonte assembled in a place  
Gyue demonstrance of an especyall grace  
Geuen to the person / & as I take the cause  
At syse smyleth bonte / where beaulte laugheth at ace  
As dayly yt is sene / and there a fynall clause.

F I N I S

Thus endeth the Beaulte of women newly Imprynted  
By Rycharde Fawkes dwellyng in duram rent





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